

Step 2:

Go to **Control Panel** from the **Start** menu and click “**Programs**”. Here, click “**Turn Windows features on or off**” under **Programs and Features**. In the list pop-up that you can see now, enable the “**Windows subsystem for Linux (beta)**” option and click **Ok**. When you see the prompt to restart your computer, click “**Restart Now**” and as the system reboots, you should be able to see the installation of the new feature.

Step 3:

After the restart, open the **Start** menu, type “**bash**” and press Enter. Since this will be the first time you run the file “**bash.exe**”, you will be prompted to accept the terms of service. After you agree to it by entering “**y**” at the prompt, the application will download the “**Bash on Ubuntu on Windows**” application from the Windows store.

With that, you are all set to start using Ubuntu's Bash shell on Windows.

Using Ubuntu's Bash shell and installing Linux software

Now you have at your disposal a full command line Bash shell based on Ubuntu. Don't forget that they are the same binaries, so you can actually use the **apt-get** command from Ubuntu to install software from Ubuntu's repositories. All Linux command line software is now accessible to you, although don't expect everything to run bug free and smoothly on the beta releases. To use the Bash shell, go to **Start** and type **bash** or **Ubuntu**, which will show you the Bash on Ubuntu on Windows application. To keep it handy, you can even pin this to your Start menu, taskbar or create a desktop shortcut.

This shell is actually a root shell, so there is no requirement to use “**sudo**”. For those not familiar, the “**root**” user on UNIX is similar to the Administrator on Windows, in terms of system access. The Windows file system can be accessed at **/mnt/c**.

You might have been used to the Windows command prompt and its commands, or perhaps you are familiar with the Linux terminal commands. You will surely find the below table useful regardless

Windows command	Bash Command
cd or chdir	cd
dir	ls
move and rename	mv
copy	cp
del or erase	rm
mkdir	mkdir
edit	vi or nano

*pointers

>>Interesting developer news



*Bash for Beginners

>>A very useful playlist for learning the basics of Bash scripting before you get started with Bash on Windows

<http://dgit.in/BashforB>



*Machine Learning

>>After the much talked about AlphaGo vs Lee Seedol match, Google launches series of videos presenting machine learning recipes.

<http://dgit.in/GoogML>



*Chromium OS for Raspberry Pi Reaches 0.5

>>Multiple cores used, better audio support, performance improvements. Here's how to install it

<http://dgit.in/ChrmRPi>



*A New Morning

>>VR Startup Magic Leap releases demo showcasing Mixed Reality in everyday life

<http://dgit.in/MLNewMorn>



Always keep in mind that the Linux environment, unlike Windows, is case sensitive. So calling for “**App.exe**” is different from calling for “**app.exe**”.

As we mentioned earlier, you will need to use the **apt-get** command to install and update applications in the Ubuntu environment. Let us get you started with some of the commands that you will need.

Command	Purpose
apt-get update	Download updated information about available packages
apt-get install packagename	Install an application package (replace “packagename” with package's name)
apt-get remove packagename	Uninstall an application package (replace “packagename” with package's name)
apt-cache search word	Search for available packages (Replace “word” with a keyword that you want to search package names and descriptions with)
apt-get upgrade	Download and Install the latest version of your installed packages

Once you install a particular application, all you need to do to run it is type its name in the prompt and press Enter. Although there might be exceptions, for which we would advise you to check the documentation of the application.

Even though you are now using Bash in Windows, always keep in mind that the Windows Command Prompt and Bash are two different environments. The software you install in the Bash shell is restricted to the Bash shell and cannot be accessed elsewhere. Also, you cannot call Windows applications from the Bash shell, even though you may have access to the same files here as the Windows environment.

Microsoft will launch this feature officially with the anniversary update to Windows 10. Even though we have explained how you can use it before that, if you do actually chose to go for it, check any associated documentation properly before you proceed. The feature is still in Beta and we would not recommend trying this out on your primary/work machine. Although if you have a machine or a system to experiment on, share your experience with us >